STRATIVA CONSULTING

IT SECURITY & GOVERNANCE POLICY

Smart Strategies. Sustainable Growth.

IT Rules and Regulations Policy

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CONFIDENTIAL & PROPRIETARY — STRATIVA CONSULTING HEADQUARTERS

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1. COMPANY INFORMATION & DOCUMENT METADATA

Strativa Consulting is a business consulting, startup development, branding, and digital marketing firm headquartered in Karachi, Pakistan. This IT Rules and Regulations Policy (Document Reference: STR-IT-POL-001) establishes comprehensive security protocols for all technological infrastructure, communication networks, and data assets.

2. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

2.1 Policy Purpose

This policy is established to safeguard Strativa Consulting's digital assets, proprietary business records, sensitive client information, and employee accounts against unauthorized access, cyber threats, data breaches, and accidental loss. As a consulting firm handling confidential startup strategies and financial models, rigorous IT governance is essential.

- **Device Protection:** Protects company-owned and approved personal devices from malware and unauthorized physical or remote access.
- **Client Data Security:** Ensures strict confidentiality and integrity of client research, financial forecasts, and brand strategies.
- **Secure Communications:** Establishes clear behavioral standards for using email, internet, cloud storage, and messaging platforms.
- **Operational Resilience:** Defines predictable protocols for incident reporting, system updates, and technology access lifecycle management.

2.2 Scope of Applicability

This policy applies universally to all employees, consultants, independent contractors, research fellows, interns, and authorized third-party vendors operating at Strativa Consulting's Karachi office or accessing company systems remotely.

The scope covers all company-owned hardware (desktops, laptops, tablets, mobile phones), approved personal devices used for work (BYOD), corporate email accounts, cloud storage platforms, software licenses, internal networks, and Wi-Fi infrastructure.

2.3 Employee Responsibilities & Legal Precedence

Every authorized user is personally responsible for exercising due diligence when using company technology. Violations of this policy expose the firm to legal and operational risks and will be addressed through fair corrective procedures.

> **LEGAL & COMPLIANCE NOTE**
>
> This IT policy operates in conjunction with applicable Pakistani laws and employment contracts. Where specific statutory cybersecurity or privacy requirements apply, they shall take precedence over internal guidelines.

3. ACCEPTABLE USE OF COMPUTERS AND COMPANY DEVICES

3.1 Device Usage & Primary Purpose

Company-issued computers, laptops, and tablets are provided primarily for conducting Strativa Consulting's professional business activities. Limited, reasonable personal use (such as checking personal mail during lunch breaks) is permissible provided it does not interfere with work duties, consume excessive bandwidth, or violate security rules.

- **Screen Locking:** Always lock device screens (Win+L or Cmd+Q) when stepping away from workstations.
- **Physical Security:** Keep physical hardware secure in locked offices or bags during transit; never leave laptops unattended in public spaces.
- **No Lending Policy:** Never lend company hardware to family members, friends, or unauthorized third parties.
- **Loss Reporting:** Report lost, stolen, or malfunctioning equipment immediately to the IT Responsible Person.

3.2 Acceptable vs. Unacceptable Use Examples

Acceptable Use (Permitted)	Unacceptable Use (Strictly Prohibited)
Using approved software for client deliverables and research.	Installing pirated software, games, or unauthorized torrent clients.
Checking corporate email and communicating with verified clients.	Accessing, downloading, or distributing adult or illegal content.
Accessing approved cloud drives and collaborative project boards.	Bypassing corporate firewalls, VPNs, or security filters.
Brief personal web browsing during official break times.	Using company devices for outside commercial businesses or freelance work.

4. INTERNET USAGE POLICY

4.1 Safe Browsing & Network Restrictions

Internet access provided by Strativa Consulting must be used responsibly. Employees must avoid suspicious websites, unverified file-sharing portals, and unauthorized software repositories. Bypassing corporate security controls or VPN tunnels is strictly prohibited.

- **Public Wi-Fi Security:** Exercise extreme caution when connecting to public Wi-Fi networks (cafes, airports); always activate the corporate VPN before accessing sensitive client files.
- **System Monitoring:** All internet traffic on corporate networks is subject to proportionate, transparent monitoring for security threat detection and bandwidth optimization.

5. OFFICIAL EMAIL AND MESSAGING POLICY

5.1 Corporate Email Etiquette & Security

Official company email accounts (ending in @strativa.pk) must be used for all client correspondence and business proposals. Employees must verify recipient addresses carefully before sending confidential attachments.

- **No Personal Email for Work:** Never use personal email accounts (Gmail, Yahoo, etc.) to transmit confidential client deliverables or financial models.
- **No Unauthorized Forwarding:** Never forward corporate emails to external unverified accounts without managerial approval.
- **Phishing Vigilance:** Inspect sender addresses and attachments thoroughly before opening; report suspicious emails immediately.

> **MFA & PASSWORD SECRECY MANDATE**
>
> Passwords, PINs, and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) approval codes must NEVER be shared with colleagues, managers, or unknown callers under any circumstances. IT staff will never ask for your password.

6. PASSWORD SECURITY AND MULTI-FACTOR AUTHENTICATION (MFA)

6.1 Practical Password Standards

Passwords are the first line of defense against unauthorized account access. All users must adhere to robust password construction rules:

- **Length & Complexity:** Use passphrases or passwords at least 12 characters long, combining uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and symbols.
- **No Password Reuse:** Never reuse corporate passwords across personal accounts or other websites.
- **Password Managers:** Use approved corporate password managers to store and generate secure credentials securely.
- **Mandatory MFA:** Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) on all email accounts, cloud drives, and remote access gateways immediately upon onboarding.
- **MFA Vigilance:** Never approve unexpected MFA push notifications or login prompts on your phone; report them immediately as potential account compromise attempts.

7. SOFTWARE INSTALLATION AND LICENSING

7.1 Software Authorization & Third-Party Tools

To prevent malware infections and copyright infringements, software installation is centrally managed. Employees are strictly prohibited from downloading or installing unapproved applications, browser extensions, or utilities.

- **Authorized Installation:** All software must be approved by the IT Responsible Person and installed via official verified repositories.
- **AI & Cloud Tool Restrictions:** Never upload confidential client information, strategic plans, or financial data to public AI tools or unapproved third-party SaaS platforms without explicit written authorization.

8. DEVICE SECURITY AND UPDATES

8.1 Endpoint Protection & Maintenance

All company devices must remain fully patched and protected against modern cyber threats.

- **OS & Security Patches:** Ensure automatic operating system updates (Windows Update / macOS Software Update) remain enabled.
- **Antivirus Compliance:** Corporate antivirus and endpoint detection tools must remain active and unmodified.
- **USB Restrictions:** Connecting unauthorized USB flash drives or external storage media is prohibited unless scanned and approved by IT.
- **Document Security:** Physical documents containing client data must be shredded securely after use; digital files must be stored in encrypted cloud repositories.

9. REMOTE ACCESS AND WORKING FROM HOME

9.1 Secure Remote Operations

Remote work requires rigorous adherence to security protocols to prevent data interception outside the office.

- **Mandatory VPN Use:** All remote access to internal resources must be conducted via the approved corporate Virtual Private Network (VPN).
- **Home Wi-Fi Security:** Connect only from secure, trusted home Wi-Fi networks protected with WPA2/WPA3 encryption and strong router passwords.
- **Visual Privacy:** Position home workstations to prevent family members or roommates from viewing confidential client information on screens.

10. DATA ACCESS PERMISSIONS AND CONFIDENTIALITY

10.1 Principle of Least Privilege & Information Classification

Data access at Strativa Consulting is governed by the principle of least privilege—employees receive only the specific access permissions required to execute their job responsibilities.

Classification Level	Access Scope	Practical Examples
1. Public	Freely accessible internally and externally.	Marketing brochures, published company website, public press releases.
2. Internal	Accessible to all Strativa staff members.	General office memos, internal meeting schedules, staff directory.
3. Confidential	Restricted to authorized project team members.	Client brand strategy decks, market research reports, financial projections.
4. Highly Restricted	Strictly limited to Executive Leadership.	Employee payroll records, legal contracts, M&A advisory files.

11. DATA STORAGE, SHARING, BACKUP, AND RETENTION

11.1 Cloud Storage & Backup Lifecycle Workflow

All official business files must be stored exclusively on approved corporate cloud repositories. Local desktop storage of client deliverables is prohibited.

- **1. Storage:** Save files directly to authorized cloud folders with role-based permissions.
- **2. Sharing:** Share documents via restricted links with expiration dates; avoid public links.
- **3. Backup:** Centralized cloud repositories execute daily automated incremental backups.
- **4. Disposal:** Retain records according to legitimate business and legal requirements; securely purge when expired.

12. PHISHING, MALWARE, AND CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS

12.1 Recognizing Cyber Threats

Employees must remain vigilant against social engineering, phishing emails, fake login prompts, and ransomware attacks. Always verify unusual requests (such as urgent wire transfers or password resets) via a trusted secondary communication channel.

13. PRIVACY AND MONITORING

13.1 Corporate Monitoring Scope

Strativa Consulting respects employee privacy; however, all corporate IT systems, networks, and email accounts are company property. System monitoring is conducted strictly for legitimate business, security, and threat-detection purposes in compliance with applicable law.

14. CYBERSECURITY INCIDENT REPORTING AND RESPONSE

14.1 Step-by-Step Incident Response Protocol

If you suspect a security breach, lost device, or phishing compromise, follow these steps immediately:

- **1. Recognize:** Recognize unusual system behavior, locked accounts, or unexpected login alerts.
- **2. Report:** Notify the IT Responsible Person immediately via phone and email (it@strativa.pk).
- **3. Detail:** Provide specific details including time observed, device ID, and error messages.
- **4. Contain:** Follow IT instructions for network disconnection or device isolation.
- **5. Preserve:** Preserve system logs and avoid deleting files independently.

14.2 Incident Report Form (Sample Template)

STRATIVA CONSULTING — CYBERSECURITY INCIDENT REPORT FORM

Reporter Name: _____ **Designation:** _____

Date & Time of Incident: _____ **Affected Device / Account:** _____

Incident Category: [ ] Phishing [ ] Lost Device [ ] Malware [ ] Data Leak

Detailed Description of Incident:

.....

Immediate Actions Taken:

.....

IT Security Verification: Signature _____ Date: _____

15. RESPONSIBILITIES AND REPORTING STRUCTURE

15.1 IT Responsibilities Across Strativa Roles

Strativa Consulting's 11 organizational roles integrate IT governance into daily operations:

Organizational Role	Primary Focus	IT & Security Responsibilities
1. Managing Director / Founder	Executive Strategy	Approves major IT policies, budget allocations, and security governance frameworks.
2. Business Strategy Consultant	Client Advisory	Ensures client strategic plans are stored in secure cloud repositories with proper access controls.
3. Project Manager	Operational Delivery	Monitors team adherence to IT security protocols and coordinates access during project onboarding.
4. Marketing Strategist	Brand & Campaigns	Ensures marketing digital assets and campaign accounts utilize strong MFA and secure credentials.
5. Brand Identity Designer	Creative Assets	Protects proprietary design files and manages secure cloud sharing links for client creative assets.
6. Market Research Analyst	Data & Intelligence	Conducts secure data collection and adheres to privacy standards when handling market research databases.
7. Financial Planning Consultant	Financial Modeling	Ensures financial forecasts and valuation models are stored in highly restricted encrypted folders.
8. Digital Marketing Specialist	Performance Ads	Manages ad accounts and social media portals with strict MFA and credential segregation.
9. Content Strategist	Copywriting	Safeguards editorial drafts and ensures secure document collaboration across approved channels.
10. Client Relationship Manager	Account Management	Maintains client data confidentiality during communications and account onboarding.
11. Web & Technology Specialist	IT & Infrastructure	Coordinates technical controls, system updates, cloud backups, firewall management, and incident response.

16. PROHIBITED IT ACTIVITIES

The following activities are strictly prohibited across all Strativa Consulting systems:

- **Account Trespass:** Unauthorized access to another employee's files, emails, or accounts.
- **Credential Sharing:** Sharing passwords, PINs, or MFA verification codes with anyone.
- **Pirated Software:** Installing pirated, cracked, or unauthorized software.
- **Disabling Security:** Disabling endpoint antivirus, firewalls, or security monitoring tools.
- **Unauthorized Data Transfer:** Transferring confidential client data to personal external storage without approval.

17. EMPLOYEE ONBOARDING, ROLE CHANGES, AND OFFBOARDING

17.1 IT Access Lifecycle & Offboarding Checklist

When employees depart Strativa Consulting, access revocation must be executed immediately:

- **1. Advance Notice:** HR notifies IT of approved departure date 48 hours in advance.
- **2. Account Revocation:** Disable corporate email, cloud drives, and VPN access.
- **3. Hardware Recovery:** Recover physical laptops, security keys, and corporate accessories.
- **4. File Transfer:** Transfer authorized project files to designated team leads.
- **5. Archiving:** Archive required business records in compliance with retention schedules.

18. POLICY VIOLATIONS AND CORRECTIVE ACTION

Policy violations are investigated fairly and objectively. Depending on severity, outcomes may include verbal coaching, mandatory security training, formal written warnings, or corrective disciplinary procedures in accordance with employment contracts and Pakistani labor laws.

19. POLICY REVIEW, APPROVAL, AND GOVERNANCE

This policy is prepared by the IT Responsible Person, reviewed by Management, checked for legal compliance, and approved by the Managing Director. It is reviewed annually or upon significant security changes.

20. EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGMENT AND COMMITMENT FORM

Please sign below to confirm receipt and understanding of the Strativa Consulting IT Rules and Regulations Policy.

IT POLICY EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGMENT DECLARATION

I hereby acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the Strativa Consulting IT Rules and Regulations Policy (Document Reference: **STR-IT-POL-001**, Version 1.0).

I agree to comply with all security standards, acceptable use guidelines, and data protection rules set forth in this document throughout my tenure.

Employee Full Name: _____

Designation / Role: _____

Department / Project: _____

Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

IT DEPARTMENT / MANAGEMENT USE ONLY:

Authorized Representative: _____

Verification Signature: _____ **Date Received:** _____